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Name .....
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FACULTY OF BUSINESS STUDIES

BUC111
BUSINESS COMMUNICATION 1

FINAL Examination / Version: B

2025-2026 / Summer

3 – September – 2026

Number of Exam Pages: 5 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Instructions:

1- Take FIVE (5) minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED OFF" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
5- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examinati
6- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
7- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
Part I	10	30 minutes	25		
Part II	5	30 minutes	25		
Part III	3	30 minutes	25		
Part IV	2	30 minutes	25		
Total	18	120 minutes	100		

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Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (25 marks)

1. When using the direct approach, you should state your main idea in the?
   A) Body
   B) Close
   C) Opening
   D) Attachment
2. Which of the following is an example of fostering goodwill?
   A) Hiring a new executive
   B) Closing a department
   C) Experiencing a product recall
   D) Praising a colleague
3. When making a claim, you should maintain a:
   A) Angry tone
   B) Sarcastic tone
   C) Professional tone
   D) Threatening tone
4. The purpose of ***resale*** statements is to?
   A) Criticize customers
   B) Build customer relationships
   C) Increase complaints
   D) Delay responses
5. Why is careful planning especially important when writing negative messages?
   A) Because negative messages are usually very long
   B) Because they aim to achieve multiple goals at the same time
   C) Because they must include technical details
   D) Because they always require legal approval
6. Which of the following statements is an example of a hasty generalization?
   A) Sales decreased by 5% after the price increase, so we need to analyze customer feedback.
   B) Two employees were late this week; therefore, all employees in the company are irresponsible.
   C) Customer satisfaction surveys show mixed results across departments.
   D) The marketing team met its target for the third quarter.
7. Why are unexpected negative announcements particularly sensitive?
   A) Because they are always confidential
   B) Because they may affect business relationships or employee morale
   C) Because they are usually short messages
   D) Because they are optional
8. What does the "D" in the AIDA model stand for?
   A) Data
   B) Demand
   C) Decision
   D) Desire
9. What should you do to find mistakes in your message?
   A) Proofread carefully
   B) Add more pictures

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C) Change the topic
D) Send it immediately

10. Which of the following is an example of an internal persuasive message?
A) A website promoting a product to customers
B) A memo requesting funds for new equipment
C) A letter asking a supplier to adjust a contract
D) A press release announcing a new product

Part II: Read the sentences below and determine: (25 marks)

a) **What type of message is it?** (Routine or Positive / Negative / Persuasive)
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** (e.g., Rejection or Refusal, Request for action or information, Performance Review, Termination, Marketing, Sales, Fostering Goodwill, etc.)

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1. "We are pleased to announce that you have received an excellent performance evaluation this year."
a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

2. "Please complete the attached employee information form and return it by the end of the day."
a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

3. "Upgrade to our premium service today and enjoy exclusive benefits at a special introductory price!"
a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

4. "Your appointment has been rescheduled to Wednesday, 15 July, at 10:00 a.m."
a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

5. "After careful consideration, we have decided not to renew your contract."
a) **What type of message is it?** ----------
b) **What specific kind of message is it?** ----------

Part III: Answer the following questions: (25 marks)

a) What are the **three parts of a routine request?**
1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------

b) What are the **four steps** to take when **responding to negative information in a digital media environment?**

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1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------
4. ----------

c) Mention **THREE** of the **legal guidelines for marketing and sales messages**.

1. ----------
2. ----------
3. ----------

Part IV: Evaluating and Crafting Business Messages: Read the case, then answer the questions that follow. (25 marks)

Background: You are Ahmed Abdelaziz, and you work for *Track Solutions* as a Senior Sales Executive. Your company has launched a new online project management app designed for small businesses. The app is user-friendly, affordable, and offers features such as task tracking, team messaging, and progress reports. Some potential customers may hesitate because they already use other tools or are concerned about switching systems.

Questions:

1. Which ***approach*** should you take to convince customers to switch to this new app? **Justify** your answer.

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2. You are Ahmed Abdelaziz, and you work for *Track Solutions* as a Senior Sales Executive. Write a *persuasive email* to Ms. Sara Hassan, the owner of a small clothing boutique, encouraging her to subscribe to the new app. Follow the criteria for writing effective persuasive messages (e.g., use the AIDA model, highlight key selling points and benefits, address possible objections, and end with a clear call to action).

To:
Subject:

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